ZIMAM

Programme at a Glance

9th ZIMAM Digital Health Forum

4 – 6 November 2026 · Jumeirah Emirates Towers, Dubai

DAY 1 · Wednesday 4 November 2026 · Forum Day		
Time	**Room 1**	**Room 2**
08:45 – 10:45	Official Opening & Plenary Session *Building the Future of Digital Health: Vision, Partnership and Action*	
11:15 – 17:15	Health AI Summit	Health Information Exchange Summit
17:15 - 17:30	MoU Signing	
18:00 – 20:00	ZIMAM Digital Health Innovation Awards	

DAY 2 · Thursday 5 November 2026 · Post-Forum Workshops		
Time	**Room 1**	**Room 2**
09:00 – 17:00	Workshop: Competency-based Framework for Digital Health Careers	Trusted Data, Connected Care: A Regenstrief Institute Terminology Workshop (Day 1 of 2)

DAY 3 · Friday 6 November 2026 · Post-Forum Workshop	
Time	**Room 2**
09:00 – 17:00	Trusted Data, Connected Care: A Regenstrief Institute Terminology Workshop (Day 2 of 2)

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Official Opening & Plenary Session

Building the Future of Digital Health: Vision, Partnership and Action

4 November 2026 · 08:45 AM – 10:45 AM

Time	Session	Speakers
PLENARY SESSION · 08:45 – 10:45 · Building the Future of Digital Health		
08:45 – 08:55	Opening **Welcome & Opening Remarks**	
08:55 – 09:20	Keynote Address **Responsible Governance in the Age of Agentic AI: Safety, Accountability and Trust in Clinical Practice**	Dr Melanie Tan, Consultant Anaesthetist & Perioperative Physician (University College London Hospitals NHS Trust); Director of Medical Informatics, Cleveland Clinic London
09:20 – 10:00	Executive Panel **Shared Vision, Shared Health: Crafting the Blueprint for the Next Generation of AI-Powered Electronic Medical Records**	**Moderator:** Dr Dari Al-Huwail, Board Member; Associate Professor, Information Science Department, Kuwait University, Kuwait **Panelists**: Yasir Khan, Clinical Director, Oracle Health and Life Sciences Baha Sayiner, General Manager, Information Technology, Medcare Hospitals and Medical Centres, UAE Charles Aunger, CIO, American Hospital Dubai, UAE Raed Rafeh, Director of Solutions and Applications Delivery, Dub ai Health Dr Shadab Khan, Senior Scientist, ADIA Lab, UAE
10:00 – 10:40	Executive Panel **From Health Sandbox to Scale: Who Will Own the Trusted Digital Health Economy?**	**Moderator:** Dr Mazin Gadir, Digital Health Expert **Panelists:** Hamid Al Mahdali, Head of Policy, Sandbox Dubai, DHA Entisar Al-Mutairi, Director, Regulatory Health Sandbox, MoH, KSA (online) Kholoud Al-Ali, Specialist, Data & Health Informatics Department, DHA

Time	Session	Speakers
10:40 – 10:45	Closing ZIMAM 2026 Highlights & Forum Preview (Video)	

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Health Information Exchange Summit 2026

From Data Exchange to Data Utility: Semantic Interoperability for Social Care and Preventive Public Health

4 November 2026 · 11:15 AM – 5:15 PM

Speaker status: Confirmed Awaiting confirmation or details Not attending in person No highlight: not on speaker tracker Different from last version

Time	Session	Speakers
MORNING SESSION · 11:15 – 13:15 · From Exchange to Utility: Setting the Scene		
11:15 – 11:20	Opening **Welcome Note & Framing: The Perspective of HIEs in the UAE's Digital Health Strategy**	Guest of Honour (TBC)
11:20 – 11:40	UAE Insights · Fireside Chat **UAE HIEs 2026: From Data Exchange to Health Data Utility — Strategy, Milestones and the Semantic Layer**	Speaker (TBC), DHA, UAE Representative, Department of Health Abu Dhabi / Malaffi (TBC)
11:40 – 12:00	GCC Insights · Keynote **HIE and Beyond: HIE Use Cases**	Representative, National Health Information Center (NHIC) / Lean Healthcare, KSA (TBC)
12:00 – 12:20	Vendor Insights · Special Fireside Chat **Boosting HIE Clinical Engagement: Agentic-AI Record Summarisation Advancements**	Dr Tamara Sunbul, Group CIO, Fakeeh Care Group Vendor X (TBC) Vendor Y (TBC)
12:20 – 12:40	Regional Spotlight · Special Lecture **Health Information Exchange in Qatar: Expanding the Data Perimeter to Include Population Health & Social Care**	Dr Juliet Ibrahim, Director of eHealth, Ministry of Public Health, Qatar
12:40 – 13:00	Learning from the World · Keynote **The Business Case for Standards in Connected Care: Highlights from the OECD Report**	Rachelle Fellner, Health Policy Researcher, OECD
13:00 – 13:15	Vendor Insights · Special Lecture **Building Connected Healthcare at Scale: Lessons from the Middle East**	Mustafa Almukhtar, Regional Director MEA, Orion Health
13:15 – 14:00	*Lunch Break*	
AFTERNOON SESSION 1 · 14:00 – 15:30 · HIE Maturity & Terminology: The Quality Imperative		

9th ZIMAM Digital Health Forum

4 NOV 2026 | DUBAI UAE

Zimam
Developing Careers in Digital Health

Time	Session	Speakers
14:00 – 14:15	Vendor Insights **Trust at Scale: Securing Patient Privacy and Compliance in HIE Systems and EHRs**	Anthony Dibble, Principal Solutions Engineer, Imprivata
14:15 – 14:50	Panel 1 · GCC & MENA Discussion Panel **HIE Maturity Models: Where Do We Stand and Where Do We Need to Go?** **Panel description:** *Drawing on the O3C Interoperability Maturity Model and the Civitas Health Data Utility Framework, this panel will map HIEs in the region to a common HIE maturity ladder. Panelists will debate what Level 3 vs Level 5 maturity means in practice, what the most common obstacles to progression are, and what investment and governance decisions are required to reach Health Data Utility status.*	**Moderator:** Rachelle Fellner, Health Policy Researcher, OECD **Panelists:** Dr Brian Dixon, Director, Center for Biomedical Informatics, Regenstrief Institute, Inc, USA Dr Ahmed Balkhair, Board Member & Governance Lead, ZIMAM, KSA Jurgen Brandstatter, Member of the Board, IHE, Austria
14:50 – 15:00	Learning from the World · Lecture **Real-World Deployment: Terminology Services for National HIE Platforms**	Joe Amlung, Senior Technical Advisor, Regenstrief Institute
15:00 – 15:20	Knowledge Transfer · Special Lecture **Unlocking the Value of HIE Data for Public Health and Population Health Analytics**	Dr Brian Dixon, Director, Center for Biomedical Informatics, Regenstrief Institute, Inc, USA
15:20 – 15:30	Vendor Highlights **Transforming Longitudinal Health Records into Research-Grade Data to Deliver Real-World Evidence (RWE)**	Tianze Zhang (Tony), Founder & CEO, LinkDoc Technology
15:30 – 15:45	*Coffee & Networking Break*	
AFTERNOON SESSION 2 · 15:45 – 17:15 · Terminology Services & Social Care Data Utility		
15:45 – 16:05	Knowledge Transfer · Fireside Chat **From Interoperability to Operability: HIEs as the Nervous System of National Command Centres**	Adjunct Professor Anita Ghose, Program Lead, AIDH, Australia Charles Aunger, CIO, American Hospital Dubai, UAE Dr Saleh Fares Al-Ali, Consultant of Emergency Medicine, EMS and Disaster Medicine, CEO, HEM360

Time	Session	Speakers
16:05 – 16:50	Panel 2 · Thematic Discussion Panel **Terminology Services as the Engine of HIE Data Quality: From Validation to Cross-Standard Mapping** **Panel description:** *Without a terminology service governing the codes that flow through an HIE, semantic drift is inevitable — local codes accumulate, LOINC adoption stalls, immunisation records lose their 360° view, and public health reports become unreliable. This panel will explain the upstream/downstream model: upstream services intercept and validate or normalise codes at ingestion, while downstream services map between standard systems to repurpose stored codes for immunisation registries, population health phenotyping and other use cases.*	**Moderator:** Dr Osama Elhassan, Specialist, Health Informatics & Smart Health Dept; Chairman & Co-Founder, Dubai Health Authority; ZIMAM, UAE **Panelists:** Representative, Malaffi / DoH Abu Dhabi Clinical Informatics, UAE (TBC) Jennifer Shivers, Strategic Technical Advisor, Global Health Informatics, Regenstrief Institute Tarek Kadoura, Director, Business Operations • Connected Care, Canada Health Infoway GCC / Egypt / Morocco practitioner sharing a regional deployment story (TBC)
16:50 – 17:05	Knowledge Transfer · Lecture **The Role of the Standards Release Center**	Tarek Kadoura, Director, Business Operations • Connected Care, Canada Health Infoway
17:05 – 17:15	Closing **Summit Summary, Key Takeaways and Call to Action: The ZIMAM Semantic Interoperability Declaration 2026**	Dr Ahmed Balkhair, Board Member & Governance Lead, ZIMAM, KSA Dr Mohammad Al Redha, DHA, UAE

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Health AI Summit 2026

Intelligence with Accountability: Shaping the Future of Health AI in the MENA Region

4 November 2026 · 11:15 AM – 5:00 PM

Speaker status: Confirmed Awaiting confirmation or details Not attending in person No highlight: not on speaker tracker Different from last version

Time	Session	Speakers
MORNING SESSION · 11:15 – 13:15 · Governing the Machine: Safety, Accountability and the Clinician		
11:15 – 11:35	Opening Keynote **Welcome and Opening Remarks — The Vision for Accountable Health AI: Lessons Learned from Europe & the US**	Guest of Honour (TBC)
11:35 – 11:55	GCC Insights · Keynote **Intelligent Hospital Roadshow — From Copilot to Orchestrator: Agentic AI in Clinical and Operational Health Systems**	H.E. Mubaraka Ibrahim, Chief Information Officer, Chief AI Officer (CIO/CAIO), Emirates Health Services
11:55 – 12:35	Knowledge Transfer · Executive Panel **The Infodemic Comes Home: AI, Misinformation and the Mental Wellbeing of Women & Adolescents**	**Moderator:** Dr Ramy Azzam, Senior Clinical Advisor, Social Prescribing Alliance Network, UAE **Panelists:** Dr Melisa Valle, Senior Research Lead, Global Digital Wellbeing Programme (Sync), King Abdulaziz Centre for World Culture (Ithra), KSA Andy Pattison, Team Lead, Frontier Technologies, WHO, Switzerland Dr Nahida Nayaz Ahmed, Chief Medical Officer, SAKINA, UAE Dr Yacin Hadjiyat, Head of Innovation, Dubai Health, UAE Further panelist (TBC)
12:35 – 12:50	Vendor Insights · Special Lecture **From Decision Support to Intelligent Orchestration: Agentic AI in Clinical and Operational Health Systems**	Romel Khalife, Country Manager – UAE and Kuwait, Oracle Health and Life Sciences

9th ZIMAM Digital Health Forum

4 NOV 2026 | DUBAI UAE

Zimam
Developing Careers in Digital Health

Time	Session	Speakers
12:50 – 13:15	UAE Insights · Fireside Chat **The Oversight Imperative — Human-in-the-Loop Design to Realise Responsible AI**	**Moderator:** Dr Ahmad Awada, Director, Innovation & Digital Health, Mediclinic ME **Speakers:** Donald Lazure, Director of Clinical Strategy, Commure, USA Dr Scott Fraser, Vice President, GCC, Heidi Health Speaker (TBC), eClinicalWorks
13:15 – 14:00	*Lunch Break*	
AFTERNOON SESSION · 14:00 – 15:30 · Scaling Responsible AI		
14:00 – 14:15	Vendor Insights **Title (TBC)**	Vendor (TBC)
14:15 – 14:55	Discussion Panel **Scaling Responsible AI for Health in Low-Resource Settings** **Panel description:** *The panel explores opportunities and challenges in scaling responsible AI for health in low-resource settings, emphasising equity, governance and sustainability. It also highlights practical strategies to implement private and cost-effective infrastructure to enable open-source LLMs and agentic AI solutions.*	**Moderator:** Dr Nour El Arnout, Associate Director, Global Health Institute, American University of Beirut **Panelists:** Dr Shadi Saleh, Founding Director, Global Health Institute; Professor of Health Systems and Financing, American University of Beirut Dr Iyad Sultan, Chief Artificial Intelligence Officer, King Hussein Cancer Center Dr Novera Ansari, Technical Officer for the Digital Health and Innovation Unit – Department of Science, Information and Dissemination, WHO Regional Office for the Eastern Mediterranean Mohammed Al Marri, Executive Director, GAFAI
15:00 – 15:20	Knowledge Transfer · Special Lecture **Health AI Governance in Hospital Settings**	Prof Ahmed Abu Salah, Healthcare Intelligence Officer, Director of the Centre for Healthcare Intelligence, King Faisal Specialist Hospital and Research Center, KSA
15:20 – 15:30	Knowledge Transfer · Special Lecture **When Digital Twin Meets Agentic AI: The Future of AI-Powered Computational Biology**	Dr Koray Atalag, Senior Consultant and Owner, GALATA-Digital
15:30 – 15:45	*Coffee & Networking Break*	
AMBIENT AI INNOVATION CONTEST · 15:45 – 17:00		
15:45 – 15:55	Contest Briefing **Testing Responsible Ambient AI Solutions for Clinical Documentation and Bedside Workflow**	

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9th ZIMAM Digital Health Forum

4 NOV 2026 | DUBAI UAE

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Developing Careers in Digital Health

Time	Session	Speakers
15:55 – 16:35	Finalist Pitches **3 Teams × 3 Pitches (2 use cases per pitch)** › *Scribing consultations (multi-language / dialects) testing* › *Suggested documentation (coding) & summarisation*	Finalist teams Jury: Dr Melanie Tan, Consultant Anaesthetist & Perioperative Physician (University College London Hospitals NHS Trust); Director of Medical Informatics, Cleveland Clinic London Dr Ahmad Awada, Director, Innovation & Digital Health, Mediclinic ME Dr Iyad Sultan, Chief Artificial Intelligence Officer, King Hussein Cancer Center
16:35 – 16:50	Judging **Jury Deliberation and Audience Voting**	Jury (Dr Melanie Tan, Dr Ahmad Awada, Dr Iyad Sultan)
16:50 – 17:00	Award **Winners Announcement**	

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Workshop: Competency-based Framework for Digital Health Careers

The Future of the Digital Health Workforce in the Age of AI

5 November 2026 · 08:00 AM – 4:10 PM

Speaker status: Confirmed Awaiting confirmation or details Not attending in person No highlight: not on speaker tracker Different from last version

Time	Session	Speakers
MORNING SESSION · 08:00 – 12:30		
08:00 – 08:45	Registration **Registration, Arrival Coffee and Networking**	Survey participation forms collected at the desk
08:45 – 09:00	Welcome **Welcome and Setting the Scene**	Mr Derrick Muneene, Chair; Director of Digital Health and Innovation | Head of Capacity Building and Collaboration of the Digital Health and Innovation Department, WHO Headquarters, Switzerland Prof Amr Jamal, Professor and Consultant of Family Medicine & Medical Informatics, King Saud University; Senior Advisor, Seha Virtual Hospital, MoH, KSA; Founding Co-Chair & Scientific Lead, ZIMAM Prof Mowafa Househ, Co-Chair; Professor, Hamad Bin Khalifa University
09:00 – 09:15	**The Landscape of UAE Healthcare Workforce Development: The Need for Clinical Informatics Fellowships**	Dr Mohammed Al-Houqani, Secretary General, NIHS
09:15 – 09:35	Opening Keynote **Celebrating the WHO Competency-based Framework for Digital Health** *› Keynote with 10 minutes of questions*	Mr Derrick Muneene, Director of Digital Health and Innovation | Head of Capacity Building and Collaboration of the Digital Health and Innovation Department, WHO Headquarters, Switzerland

9th ZIMAM Digital Health Forum

4 NOV 2026 | DUBAI UAE

Zimam
Developing Careers in Digital Health

Time	Session	Speakers
09:35 – 09:50	Launch **The ZIMAM × WHO EMRO Digital Health Workforce Survey** *› Joint launch, instrument walkthrough and call for participation*	Dr Novera Ansari, Technical Officer for the Digital Health and Innovation Unit – Department of Science, Information and Dissemination, WHO Regional Office for the Eastern Mediterranean Prof Amr Jamal, Professor and Consultant of Family Medicine & Medical Informatics, King Saud University; Senior Advisor, Seha Virtual Hospital, MoH, KSA; Founding Co-Chair & Scientific Lead, ZIMAM WHO EMRO leadership
09:50 – 10:10	International Session (online) **Incorporating AI in Digital Health Competency-based Frameworks**	Australasian Institute of Digital Health (AIDH), Australia Online · 16:50 – 17:10 Sydney time
10:10 – 10:45	Executive Panel **Leveraging Multilateral Platforms for Preparing an AI-fluent Healthcare Workforce**	**Moderator:** Dr Dari Al-Huwail, Board Member; Associate Professor, Information Science Department, Kuwait University, Kuwait **Panelists:** Brian Francesca, Executive Council Member, Arab Hospitals Federation, UAE Dr Shadi Saleh, Founding Director, Global Health Institute; Professor of Health Systems and Financing, American University of Beirut Prof Umit Cali, Professor & Founding Director of ARC, AUS, UAE
10:45 – 11:05	Fireside Chat **The Future of Digital Healthcare Workforce in the Intelligent Hospitals of Tomorrow**	Jamal Masalmeh, IT & Digital Health Expert, Emirates Health Services, UAE Raed Rafeh, Director of Solutions and Applications Delivery, Dubai Health, UAE
11:05 – 11:20	*Coffee Break and Networking*	
11:20 – 11:55	Keynote (10 min) + Fireside Chat **Women Leadership in Digital Health: A Digital Health Fellowship Program**	Adj Prof Anita Ghose, Program Lead, AIDH, Australia Dr Tamara Sunbul, Group CIO, Fakeeh Care Group Reenita Das, Co-founder, Chief Transformation Officer, NXT Horizon
11:55 – 12:10	Keynote **Bridging the Talent Gap in AI Governance**	Brian Francesca, Executive Council Member, Arab Hospitals Federation, UAE
12:10 – 12:30	Fireside Chat **Interoperability Competencies in the Age of AI**	Dr Koray Atalag, Senior Consultant and Owner, GALATA-Digital Ilya Beda, Interoperability Expert, Australia

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4 NOV 2026 | DUBAI UAE

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Developing Careers in Digital Health

Time	Session	Speakers
12:30 – 13:30	*Lunch Break and Dhuhr Prayers*	
AFTERNOON SESSION · 13:30 – 16:10		
13:30 – 14:15	**Researcher Presentation Panel** **Evidence on AI and the Digital Health Workforce** *› 10 minutes per presenter*	**Moderator:** Prof Mowafa Househ, Professor, Hamad Bin Khalifa University **Presenters:** Hana Abu Sharib, Nursing Informatics Manager, Sheikh Shakhbout Medical City Dr Rawad Hodeify, Associate Professor of Medical Biotechnology; Chairperson of Biotechnology Department; IEEE AI Ethics Lead Assessor, American University of Ras Al Khaimah Dr Mohammed El-Hadidi, Birmingham University, UAE MBZUAI speaker (TBC)
14:15 – 14:35	**Knowledge Transfer (online)** **Preparing for Creating and Working in Interoperable Organisations**	Dr Henrique Martins, Portugal Online · 10:15 – 10:35 Lisbon time
14:35 – 15:10	**Academic Panel** **Bridging the Gap between University Outcomes and Market Requirements in Digital Health Transformation**	**Moderator:** Prof Amr Jamal, Professor and Consultant of Family Medicine & Medical Informatics, King Saud University; Senior Advisor, Seha Virtual Hospital, MoH, KSA; Founding Co-Chair & Scientific Lead, ZIMAM **Panelists:** Dr Ikram Rehman, Associate Professor, Middlesex University, UAE Jamal Masalmeh, IT & Digital Health Expert, Emirates Health Services, UAE Raed Rafeh, Director of Solutions and Applications Delivery, Dubai Health, UAE
15:10 – 15:25	*Coffee Break*	
15:25 – 15:45	**Keynote** **The Road to MEDINFO 2027: Reflecting Health/Medical Informatics in MENA to the World**	Prof Mowafa Househ, Professor, Hamad Bin Khalifa University
15:45 – 16:00	**Keynote (online)** **Highlights on the WHO Competency-based Framework**	Dr Taghreed Justinia, Expert Panel Member, Global Digital Health & AI Competency Framework, World Health Organization
16:00 – 16:10	**Closing** **Closing Remarks and Recommendations** *› Recommendations read back with named owners*	All three Chairs

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